

KDE announces Plasma Mobile, a Linux OS for phones

The KDE community recently introduced a free and open source mobile operating system named the Plasma Mobile. The community had planned for such an initiative even before Ubuntu Touch was announced. Users can reportedly switch from one interface to another, as Plasma 5 on the desktop comes with a converged shell. If the reports are to be believed, KDE wanted to launch tablets integrated with Plasma software. However, this plan was never executed. Plasma Mobile was unveiled at KDE's Annual Academy World Summit. As Plasma Mobile happens to be a free open source operating system, it can be distributed, modified as well as re-used without any restrictions.

Designed as an inclusive system, Plasma Mobile supports various applications. While native applications can be written in Qt, KDE's choice of toolkit, Plasma Mobile also comes with the support for GTK apps, Ubuntu Touch apps, Sailfish OS apps and even Android apps. The current Plasma Mobile is running on top of Kubuntu and is built on top of KDE technologies like the KDE frameworks, Qt toolkit and Kwin window manager.



Linux Foundation expands access to Linux training and certification for aspiring professionals in India

The Linux Foundation, the nonprofit organisation dedicated to accelerating the growth of Linux and collaborative development, has announced the availability of country-specific pricing for its 'Essentials of Systems Administration' course and for the 'Linux Foundation Certified System Administrator' exam for individuals in India. From now, individuals with an Indian issued credit card and address can register for a course-plus-exam bundle for an introductory rate of ₹ 5,000 (US\$79). Part of The Linux Foundation's mission is to grow the Linux community and expand access for those who wish to become Linux professionals. To do so, the Foundation has launched a range of initiatives, including the free 'Intro to Linux' course via edX; made it possible to take certification exams anywhere, anytime; provided the 'Essentials of Systems Administration' course in Spanish, with the Portuguese version to follow; awarded scholarships for training courses to deserving individuals; and offered training and certification at rates lower than those offered by traditional providers. However, in some areas around the world, additional programmes are still needed to increase access to Linux learning materials.

India is second only to the United States with regard to inquiries about Linux Foundation training and certification but ranks among the lowest in Linux certification exam enrollment. It is clear that this population of IT professionals



Ubuntu Software Center no longer supports DEB files

Though some developers might think about an upgrade for Ubuntu,



the future of the software centre remains uncertain.

Ubuntu makes

use of DEB files which is no longer considered a feasible way of providing updates through the Ubuntu Software Center. However, even if Canonical is aware of this problem, the UK based firm does not seem willing to share details regarding the future of the software centre. Meanwhile, projects like Ubuntu MATE are no longer relying on the Ubuntu Software Center.

Canonical also forgot to inform developers that from now on, for their applications in the Ubuntu Software Center, they cannot offer updates for the latest Ubuntu version. This means that you won't be able to find the dmmedia converter in the Software Center if you work on Ubuntu 15.04.

"Unfortunately, we haven't fixed your problem because as it stands, we can't afford to. The DEB based store has continued to be a huge problem over time and in fact, it has been increasingly expensive to keep it running. As it stands today, we won't enable uploads to newer Ubuntu releases. It requires significant manual work that sometimes drags on for weeks. We all agree the current situation with DEB based files isn't one to be proud of, and I expect we'll announce a more definitive plan on its future soon," revealed Martin Albiseti, director of online services.

While it is anticipated that Canonical wants to keep the DEB based Ubuntu, we wonder what would happen to the third party software which cannot be updated in the official store.